previous one had already made clear: more than 80 percent of Israelis consider Netanyahu and his coalition as partly responsible for the Hamas attack and want him out. Unfortunately, that cannot happen now. In short, Israel is facing the worst crisis of its history, under the worst possible internal conditions.

Gal Hirsch is the Israeli official appointed to supervise the hostage issue. Today Hirsch invited foreign diplomats to his office and shouted at them that the “Oslo Agreements” were responsible for the present situation. None of these diplomats had anything to do with agreements signed in the 1990s; some of them had not even been born by then. They left the meeting aghast. Hirsch’s performance is an allegory for what goes on.

It is extremely difficult to get a clear picture of Israeli public opinion right now. The polls give some indications and so do multiple other sources, but any attempt at an overall assessment reveals a set of contradictory trends. The October 7 attack certainly revived a sense of a community of fate that had not existed in the country for a long time. The polls point to the persistence of widespread anger against the government and, more widely, against all individuals in positions of leadership, including military leaders, who demonstrated such horrendous incompetence, lack of preparation, and misplaced confidence. If the aforesaid is correct, one cannot avoid asking the obvious question: can the sense of a community of fate sustain a readiness to fight and bear unavoidable heavy sacrifices, despite simmering anger against the country’s leadership? In October 1973, the same question could have been asked, but the war was short, and defeat turned into victory rapidly enough not to put the country to the test. This time one speaks of prolonged fighting for weeks and possibly months. On top of it, many commentators report that Netanyahu has not “been himself” since October 7, and some have pointed to the photo of his embrace with Biden, in which he seems to lean into the arms of the American president. Of course, the mere pounding of Gaza does not put the country to the test,